

Reform UK – Harrogate & Knaresborough

Soft-Tone Public Persuasion Sheet (For Lib Dem-Leaning Voters)

1. Illegal Migration & Foreign Criminal Deportations

“I completely understand why people feel sympathy for families risking everything to cross the Channel. But here in Harrogate, families wait years for housing while millions go on hotel bills for illegal arrivals. Both groups matter. The real villains are smugglers and foreign criminals. Reform wants firm, fair borders, fast removal of illegal entrants and offenders, and safe legal routes.”

2. Net Zero & Energy Costs

“Caring about the planet is a good instinct. But families in Harrogate are struggling with higher bills now. The issue isn’t renewables—it’s relying on them before the grid is ready. Reform backs British nuclear and domestic energy to cut bills and still go green sensibly.”

3. BBC Bias

“The BBC has created brilliant programmes, no doubt. But pensioners shouldn’t be fined for not paying a political tax. Reform wants the BBC to be optional—if it earns trust, people will subscribe.”

4. High Street Closures

“Everyone wants a thriving town centre. But rising costs mean Harrogate is losing loved businesses like Brood Coffee House and Lancaster’s Bakery. Reform wants to cut NI, ease pressures, and revive our high street.”

5. Women’s Safe Spaces

“Respect for everyone matters. But women escaping abuse need guaranteed female-only spaces. Reform backs protecting women’s spaces while providing respectful separate provision for trans people.”

Why This Won’t Hurt Businesses:

“Most businesses already have a single-user unisex toilet or private cubicle. That already serves as a respectful private space. No building work, no new rooms. Women’s spaces stay protected, and privacy is handled with existing facilities. It’s cheaper and simpler than current confusing rules.”

6. Child Transitioning

“It’s kind to support distressed young people, but puberty blockers have caused harm—Tavistock clinicians said so. Reform supports mental health first, and no irreversible treatments for minors.”

7. Full-Term Abortion & Assisted Suicide Concerns

“Everyone wants women in crisis to be supported — that instinct to care is a strength. But proposals allowing full-term abortion and pushing assisted suicide without strong safeguards risk putting vulnerable babies and elderly people at risk. Reform backs real support for mothers and firm protections for life at both ends.”

Closing Line:

“Reform balances compassion with fairness. Helping people here at home while still caring about others. A balanced approach for Harrogate & Knaresborough.”

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Volunteer / Activist Training Sheet (Soft Tone)

Core Method: The Four-Step Approach

1. Mirror Empathy: “I understand why you feel that way...”
2. Local Impact: Bring it back to Harrogate concerns.
3. Safe Villain: Smugglers, consultants, bureaucracy—not the voter.
4. Third Way: “Same heart—smarter approach.”

Business Cost Question – Key Script

“Not at all. Almost every business already has a unisex cubicle or private toilet — that’s the respectful private space. No new construction, no new cost. Women’s spaces stay women’s spaces, and anyone needing privacy already has it. It’s cheaper and clearer than the current system.”

Illegal Migration & Deportations

“Totally understand why people care about Channel families. But Harrogate families are waiting for housing while hotel bills rise. Smugglers are the villains. Reform: firm borders, quick removals, safe legal routes.”

Energy Costs

“Good instinct to protect the planet. But bills here are crushing people. Need renewables plus reliable British energy.”

BBC Bias

“BBC has great content, but the licence fee hits pensioners. Reform: voluntary subscription.”

High Street

“Closures like Brood Coffee House and Lancaster’s Bakery hurt real families. Reform cuts NI and burdens.”

Women’s Spaces

“Safeguarding women AND respectful provision using existing unisex cubicles. No extra cost to businesses.”

Child Transitioning

“Mental health first, no irreversible treatments for minors.”

Full-Term Abortion & Assisted Suicide

“It’s natural to care about women in crisis. But full-term abortion and weak assisted-dying safeguards put vulnerable babies and elderly people at risk. Reform says: support mothers, protect life at both ends. Kindness + boundaries.”

Objection Pivot:

“We can care about women and protect vulnerable people — it’s not either/or.”

DOs:

- Stay calm, warm, friendly.
- Praise compassion.
- Use Harrogate examples.
- Keep responses under 20 seconds.
- Pivot to: “Fairness + compassion.”

DON'Ts:

- Don't mock Lib Dems.
- Don't attack individuals.
- Don't go too heavy on detail.
- Don't argue emotion with logic.”

Objection Responses:

“That seems harsh.”

“Actually it's about fairness for everyone.”

“We need renewables.”

“Absolutely—just with reliable backup so bills stay low.”

“We should help migrants.”

“Completely agree—safely, without rewarding smugglers.”

Closing Line:

“Reform isn't harsh. It's balanced, fair, and realistic for Harrogate.”

APPENDIX: Tom Gordon MP — Documented Positions (Evidence Summary)

- Assisted Dying: Voted FOR at Second Reading (Division 51, 29 Nov 2024) and Third Reading (Division 245, 20 June 2025). Publicly welcomed the vote as a “compassionate and historic decision.”
- Abortion Decriminalisation: Voted FOR New Clause 1 (Crime & Policing Bill, 17 June 2025) removing criminal liability from women for terminating a pregnancy at any gestation.
- Puberty Blockers: Publicly supported overturning the national puberty-blocker emergency ban, per Stray Ferret reporting and his own social-media comments.